Moe Aguilar's Writing Samples

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Writing Dialogue Samples

Prologue:

The first day back at CMU. Time to return to the source of all your pride, and let's be honest, all your stress. You're heading to a guest lecture, when suddenly-

WHAM. You crash into someone.

Norma: Wow. Just... wow. Do you make a habit of running over strangers or am I special?
... Actually, you're kinda cute. I'm Norma. And you are...?

Player Choices:

A) The person who just found the prettiest speed bump on campus.
B) Still recovering from the impact. Give me your name again?
C) Uh... sorry?

Norma's reaction changes based on choice:

For A: Smooth. Too bad I don't date traffic hazards.
For B: Norma. Say it right and maybe I won't sue for damages.
For C: Wow. That was... painfully sincere.

Norma: Anyway, I've got things to do and you've got...a mirror to find. Later!

Before you can process this, someone else appears.

Poli: Don't mind her! She's like that with everyone. Mostly. I'm Poli! And you're…
Late for the lecture. And you forgot your student ID today. And you really should check your bike's brakes.

Player Choices:

A) How do you even know that?
B) Are you stalking me or just obsessed?
C) Wait, my bike does need repairs...

Poli: Student government perks! Now come on. My brother Lawrence is already annoyed we're late.

They drag you toward the lecture hall.

Inside, a tall guy glares at his watch. He looks up as you enter.

Lawrence: Poli. You're late. Again. And you brought...?

Poli: A new friend! They were busy getting personal with Norma.

Lawrence: How... unfortunate for them.
Don't expect special treatment. I don't care who you've been... colliding with.

Player Choices:

A) Noted. I'll aim my next collision at someone friendlier.
B) Don't worry, I'll make it up to you. Coffee after the lecture?
C) Cool. What's the lecture about?

Lawrence's reaction changes based on choice:

For A: Please do.
For B: This isn't a negotiation. And I don't drink coffee.
Poli: You literally have an americano in your hand.
For C: Finally, someone asking the right questions. It's about AI Ethics. Though given tonight's speaker, it might devolve into a circus.

Lawrence: The lecture already started actually.

Quest Sample

Grass Island Quest: Find the Ancient Plants

Brickardo: You're here! Good.
My math said somebody would come.
I'm Brickardo, Landscape Architect of the Rundkantar Reconstruction Team.
The old growers, they engineered living architecture.
They built harmony with this whole island.
And they even learned to sing with the volcano!
They grew plants with incredible qualities.
From flowers that filtered noise to the softest grass you've ever touched.
But these plants are going extinct.
I need to collect at least 4 of them to rebuild their garden and..
Maybe make the mountain happy again.
The plants should be scattered nearby. Can you retrieve them?

Brickardo: I may also need something to help me tolerate the bright sunlight on this island.
I think my cat had my Sun-goggles. but I'm not sure.

<u>If Player finds Sun-goggles and talks to Brickardo after:</u>
Brickardo: Thank you so much! I will be able to build more comfortably now. :)

<u>Clues the Player gets after finding the accommodation (Sun-goggles):</u>

1. You should try looking on top of the tallest mountain as well.
2. The old records say there's one 'besides the cat shaped rock'.
3. The old records say there's one 'next to the lion statue, at its feet'.
4. There's one 'in the ruins with three arches, under the middle one'.

<u>If Player finds the Plants:</u>
Brickardo: Thanks! Now we can build the garden.

Sand Island Quest: Collect all the Crystals

Legorreta: Hi! You made it to the sand island we found!
My name is Legorreta.
I am in charge of retrieving and categorizing relics from the Rundkantar.
You can say I'm sort of a curator.
I've been trying to finish this collection of crystals to rebuild a relics museum.
So far I have found 2.
But they're still 4 missing and I keep getting lost because of all of the sand.
Everything looks the same here.
The old stories say that when all the relics are together…

The island's heart might beat again.
There's four crystals here. Can you find them?

Legorreta: Ugh, these singing sands are overstimulating me.

<u>If Player finds Earplugs and talks to Legorreta after:</u>
Legorreta: Wow, I really needed this. Thank you so much!

<u>Clues the Player gets after finding the accommodation (Earplugs):</u>

1. There may be one 'next to the broken pots'.
2. The 'tallest cactus' should have a secret next to it.
3. There is one hidden 'within a block surrounded by rocks'.
4. There should be another 'within a block close to water'.

<u>If Player finds the Plants:</u>
Legorreta: Yay! Now we can build the museum.

<u>Ice Island Quest: Find the Hospital Blueprints</u>

Blockberto: Oh, hello there.
I'm Blockberto. In charge of exploration in the Rundkantar Reconstruction Team.
Oh my god, it's so cold here.
I mean. Cold? Pfft!
The volcano's been sleeping for so long, everything just... froze.
Wait, we don't have time for this!
We need to find the blueprints before the ice island starts to melt.
I have to find 4 blueprints scattered here to rebuild a hospital.
But we only have a small window of time before the ice starts to melt.
I've got a theory that finishing this will wake the volcano up.
And a little geothermal heat would be GREAT right now.
Can you help me retrieve the blueprints?

Blockberto: I need a timer or something to keep me focused on this task.

<u>If Player finds Timer and talks to Blockberto after:</u>
Blockberto: This is perfect for my time blindness! Thanks!

<u>Clues the Player gets after finding the accommodation (Timer):</u>

1. There should be one at 'the tallest point in the island'.
2. Climb the slippery staircase. The blueprint's stuck to the last step.
3. There are some steamy rocks holding one, find it after they melt.
4. There should be one beneath a broken bridge.

<u>If Player finds the Blueprints:</u>
Blockberto: You’re a life-saver! Now we can build the hospital.

Character Sketch

- The Architect (Autistic)
  - Traits: Routine, precision, predictive thinking
  - Can spot structural flaws invisible to others (highlights weak points, parts that are missing in the construction)
  - Encyclopedic knowledge of lost civilization's architecture
  - Becomes disoriented when plans change suddenly
  - Teaches players by using Brick Club plans (which parts the player needs to find in the map)
  - How players support their needs: Give warnings before changing anything, give the character recovery time after sensory overload (too many changes means taking a small break from building)
- The Curator (Autistic):
  - Traits: Pattern recognition, sensory sensitivity, special interests
  - Archaeology enthusiast
  - Instantly spots connections between artifacts
  - Overwhelmed by bright lights/loud sounds in caves
  - How players support their needs: Find sensory tools (goggles, ear plugs), respect organizational systems
- The Explorer (AuDHD): Time-pressure focus, risk-taking
  - Traits: Time blindness, time-pressure focus, risk-taking
  - Ancient navigation expert
  - Solves problems fastest when under time constraints
  - Loses track of non-urgent tasks (forgets to mark maps)
  - Impulsive decisions sometimes backfire
  - How players support their needs: Set hourglass timers for quests (craftable item), mark maps for them
  - Bonus: Could unlock speed-run challenges